

Strategic Themes & Roadmap

Feature B7 (VSC-2) · Strategy gets a home, the solution level its integrated roadmap.

What is it?

Two SAFe gaps from the workshop: strategic themes have no structured home, and there is no large-solution roadmap with initiative swimlanes. Now: themes with epic links and a roadmap matrix across trains — near-term granular, far-term coarse (P1 · P2 · Y1 · Y2 · Y3).

How to use it

```
// themes.json, in the config: "themes": "themes.json"
{"themes": [{"id": "T-1", "title": "Digital ordering"}],
"epics": [
  {"id": "EP-1", "title": "Portal", "train": "ART A",
   "horizon": "P1", "theme": "T-1", "status": "in_progress"},
  {"id": "EP-9", "title": "Legacy rewrite", "train": "ART C",
   "horizon": "Y1"}}] // empty theme = zombie
```

What the report shows

- Orphan detection in both directions: a theme with no epics = 'declared & forgotten' (red, judged portfolio-wide); an epic without a theme = zombie initiative
- Typo protection: a wrong theme reference is a validation error, not a silent zombie
- Roadmap matrix trains × horizons, zombies red; zombie list below
- Conference pre-read: the view is input 4 of the VSC bundle
- D2 hook: epics flow into snapshots — the delta briefing documents 'updated roadmaps' per conference (P2 → P1, theme lost → 'zombie')

Guardrails

Horizons stay deliberately coarse in the distance — no fake precision across years. The tool judges structure only (orphaned/zombie); whether an initiative is strategically right remains a human judgement in the conference.